

the very same attitude as in Daniel toward Israel and toward Babylon ; of ardent attachment to his land and to his people, and of the most perfect loyalty to the government under which he lives as a captive.

The delicate handling of prophetic truth, as affecting this double relation, is brought out in a most remarkable manner in the thirty-sixth chapter of his prophecies. The prophet has uttered his oracles against the heathen nations, against Moab and Ammon, against Tyre and Sidon, against Philistia, Edom, and Egypt. Babylon alone has been omitted, and it may be said not unnaturally hitherto, because Babylon is the instrument of Divine judgment against these seven nations. But the prophecy in the thirty-sixth chapter is for the land of Israel, which is now desolate, and has been laid waste for years under the destroying sway of Babylon. This prophecy contains a promise of a new heart and other promises for Israel, that stretch onward past our own time ; but its predictions are very specific on the return of the people, the rebuilding of the cities, and the restoration of the wastes : "The enemy hath said against you, Aha, even the ancient high places are our's in possession. . . . But ye, O mountains of Israel, ye shall shoot forth your branches, and yield your fruit to my people of Israel ; for they are at hand to come. . . . And ye shall dwell in the land that I gave to your fathers" (vers. 2, 8, 28). For this end the one great and essential event is the breaking of the yoke of Babylon, to set Israel at liberty to return to his own land ; yet the prophet, speaking as he is moved by the Holy Ghost, never speaks of Babylon, but carefully avoids the mention of the name, even when referring to the enemies from whom Israel is to be delivered : "Surely in the fire of my jealousy have I spoken against the residue of the heathen, and against all Idumea, which have appointed my land into their possession with the joy of all their heart. . . . I will take you from among the heathen, and gather you out of all countries, and will bring you into your own land" (vers. 5, 24). Idumea and Egypt, and all heathen